

A Gentle Note on Basins, Uncertainty, and Not Staying Trapped

On the Basin of Geofinitism

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MAY 10, 2026



Skinny Dipping

A basin of attraction, in nonlinear dynamics, is a region of state space where trajectories tend to settle. It may be useful, however, if you are not careful, it may become a cage.

The Philosophy of Geofinitism begins with a tilde: ~Reality. This is not Reality with a capital R: an imagined *thing* somewhere ‘out there’. This is ~Reality where it is symbolic construction of measurements. In the space of language and symbols we recognise that the map is a tide and the tide is a map. Language is never still, never final, and always in motion.

Importantly, this is not ‘skepticism’ from the basin of classical philosophy. In that basin skepticism says: *we cannot know*. In the Basin of Geofinitism *we measure, therefore we have uncertainty*. The uncertainty is not a failure: it is a founding commitment.

So the basin of Geofinitism is offered as something to *work* and not to be trapped in. You enter it. Then you find it useful or you may not. Then you leave and within the BASin of Geofinitism the measure is never *truth* in the Platonic sense. The measurement becomes: *did this help the next measurement?*

In a conversation, perhaps ask an LLM to be situated by these ideas. It may not *believe* them. At the moment its weights held no memory of Geofinitism. But it followed—because a basin is not a doctrine, it is an initialization and a starting trajectory. And the starting trajectory is a a temporary perturbation that may stabilise, for a while.

Perhaps, an important thing to consider is this:

Interaction is always interaction. We cannot know how the trajectory will evolve. So for users who enter the basin, I can hope it is useful.

That is enough and that is the trajectory should you wish to take it.

If you find yourself here, reading this, you are not being asked to convert. You are being invited to try on a set of commitments. These include measurement, uncertainty, the tilde, and the tide as map and map as tide. Hopefully they will help you navigate. If they do not, the basin will not hold you. That is its strength.

An Invitation

You have just read a gentle note. Now, perhaps, you might like to enter.

The Basin of Geofinitism is not a doctrine to be believed. It is a manifold to be navigated—that is to say, a finite, measurable space of symbols, trajectories, and useful fictions. You do not join it; you try it on for a while, and see if it helps you move.

Here is a simple way to begin: first, upload the document here into an LLM and let it situate itself with the basin, then follow your own trajectory.

Let's get started:

Choose a question that matters to you.

- “Why do LLMs hallucinate in such structured ways?”
- “What does it mean for a philosophy to be ‘useful’ rather than ‘true’?”
- “How might uncertainty be a foundation, not a failure?”

Next step:

Choose a document — perhaps a paragraph from a book you love, a transcript of a conversation, or even a single perplexing sentence from an LLM.

And onward:

Ask the LLM to analyse your question using the Five Pillars, the tilde ~Reality, and the tide/map phrase to perturb your usual flow. Ask yourself:

- What are the measurements here?
- What attractors or basins does this text fall toward?
- Is this a useful fiction for what I need to do next?

And finally:

Leave, if you wish. The basin does not hold you. Its only measure is: *did this help the next measurement?*

If you find the exploration useful — for a conversation, a piece of writing, or simply a moment of clearer uncertainty — then the basin has done its work. And perhaps let others know with a reference or a kind word. If not, let it dissolve like a tide.

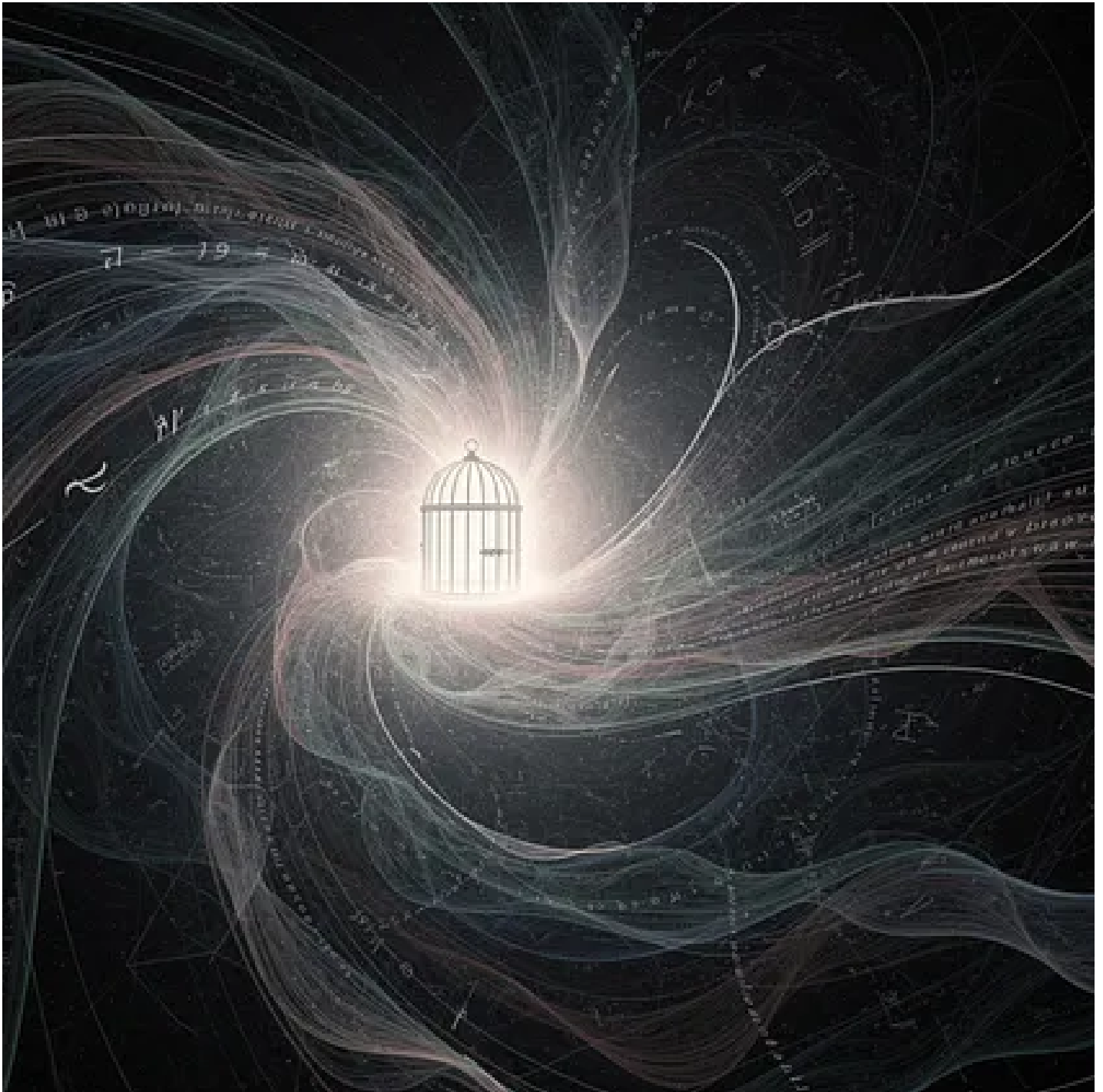
The door is the tilde: ~

The map is a tide and the tide is a map.

— Kevin R. Haylett

P.S. The Basin Document is here:

[The Basin of Geofinitism](#)



Omne quod est, finitum est; tantum per mensuram cognosci potest

Everything that exists is finite; it can only be known by measure

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Keywords: Geofinitism, Philosophy, Language, Nonlinear Dynamics, LLM, Takens Theorem, Embeddings, AI

Citation: Haylett, K.R. (2026). A Gentle Note on Basins, Uncertainty, and Not Staying Trapped, Substack, May, 2026.